

may well have been. Cyrus reigned over a people among whom Aryans were at best a small minority,¹ but his own Aryan descent² is emphatically endorsed by the statement of Darius that he was "of our family" (*Bh* i. 10), that is, the Achæmenian. According to the Assyrian inscription of Cyrus, he was son of "King Cambyses of the city Ansan," who was son of Cyrus, son of Teispes, both also Kings of Ansan. This makes Hystaspes, Darius's father, third cousin to Cyrus, Teispes (*Caišpiš*) being a common ancestor. If we are to take Darius literally, we can make him "ninth" in royalty by counting the royal line of Ansan from Achæmenes to Cyrus, fifth in succession, and then adding the (younger?) branch Ariaramnes, Arsames, Hystaspes, Darius. The difficulty is that neither Hystaspes nor his father and grandfather are ever called kings. If they exercised any kind of royalty, it must have been in some other province, such as Parthia, where Hystaspes wins a victory for Darius in *Bh* ii. 16. It may be noticed that Darius

¹ Compare E. Meyer's statement (*Enc. Brit.*¹¹, xxi. 203) that the kings of the Mitanni on the Euphrates bore Iranian names, but ruled over people speaking non-Iranian language. Meyer, by the way, makes the Medes Iranian: they reached W. Iran before 900 B.C.

² The names *Kūruš* and *Kambūjiya* are of disputed etymology, but there is no reason whatever to doubt their being Aryan. I do not think there has been any suggestion more attractive than that made long ago by Spiegel (*Altpers. Keilinsch.*², 96) that they attach themselves to Skt *Kuru* and *Kamboja*, originally Aryan heroes of fable, whose names were naturally revived in a royal house. Spiegel thinks that the myths about Cyrus may have originated in confusion between the historical and the mythical heroes. (*Kamboja* is a geographical name, and so is *Kuru* often: hence their appearance in Iranian similarly to-day as *Kur* and *Kamoj*.)